# 6.1 Gastroesophageal Reflux Disease (GERD)

| Assessment | Nursing Diagnosis | Plan / Expected Outcome | Nursing Interventions | Evaluation |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Subjective**<br>• "I have burning behind my chest after meals."<br>• Worse when he lies down<br>**Objective**<br>• Food comes back up<br>• Takes antacids every day | **ACTUAL**<br>**Acute pain** related to acid reflux into the esophagus as evidenced by retrosternal burning after meals. | Within 1 week, says the heartburn is less. | • Give the proton pump inhibitor before breakfast, as prescribed.<br>• Advise small meals and nothing to eat in the 2–3 hours before bed.<br>• Raise the head of the bed by 15–20 cm.<br>• He should avoid fatty food, coffee, smoking and tight clothes. | Fewer symptoms: **goal met**. |
| **Subjective**<br>• "I did not know food affects this."<br>**Objective**<br>• Eats late at night<br>• Drinks coffee several times a day | **ACTUAL**<br>**Deficient knowledge** related to lifestyle measures as evidenced by unhealthy eating pattern. | Before discharge, names three changes he will make to his lifestyle. | • Teach which foods set it off, and weight loss if he is overweight.<br>• Give the advice in writing. | Lists his changes: **goal met**. |
| **Subjective**<br>• *No specific complaint*<br>**Objective**<br>• Reflux at night<br>• Coughs at night | **RISK**<br>**Risk for aspiration** as evidenced by risk factors: reflux of gastric contents at night. | No aspiration and no night cough. | • Keep the head of the bed raised 15–20 cm.<br>• No meals in the 2–3 hours before lying down.<br>• Give the acid-reducing medicine as prescribed. | No cough, no chest infection: **goal met**. |